

Light

Most dungeons are dark and it is necessary for characters to bring their own light source with them. A torch or lantern will cast light 30 feet in all directions. A torch will burn out in 6 turns (1 hour); a lantern filled with one flask of oil will burn out in 24 turns (4 hours). It is important to remember which characters are carrying light sources. A character could not, for example, carry a lit torch, a drawn sword, and a shield at the same time.

INFRAVISION: Infravision is the ability to “see” heat patterns. Most living things give off heat. To infravision, warm things are bright, cool things are gray, and cold things are black. Infravision is useless in normal or magical light. Infravision cannot be used to read without light. All non-human monsters have infravision.

Doors

NORMAL DOORS: Doors in a dungeon are usually closed, and are often stuck or locked. A lock must usually be picked by a thief. An unlocked door must be forced open to pass through it. To force open a door, roll 1d6; a result of 1 or 2 (on 1d6) means that the door is forced open. The roll should be adjusted by a character's Strength score adjustment. The number needed to open a door can never be less than 1 nor greater than 1-5.

Once a door is opened, it will usually swing shut when released unless it is spiked or wedged open. Doors will usually open automatically for monsters, unless the door is held, spiked, or closed with magical spells.

SECRET DOORS: A secret door is any door that is hidden or concealed. A secret door usually does not look like a door; it may be a sliding panel or hidden under a rug. Any character has a 1 in 6 chance of finding a secret door; any elf has a 2 in 6 chance. The DM should *only* check for finding a secret door if a player says that the character is searching for one and searching for one in the correct area. The search takes one turn. Each character has only one chance to find each secret door.

LISTENING: A character may try to listen at a door to hear what is on the other side. For each character listening, the DM should roll 1d6. A result of 1 (1 or 2 for demi-humans) means that the character hears any noises being made by the creatures on the other side of the door (if any). Each character may only try once per door. Thieves have special chances to “hear noise” (see page B8). The undead do not make any noise.

Retainers

A retainer (or hireling) is a person hired by a player character (PC) to aid that character on an adventure. The number of retainers who will follow a PC is limited by that character's Charisma score. If a retainer is not well-treated, he or she is likely to stop working for the PC and will tell others of the mistreatment. Retainers are more than just men-at-arms, soldiers hired to fight and protect their employer but only expected to take reasonable risks. Retainers are lieutenants or assistants to a PC and are expected to lend their skills and knowledge to the benefit of the party and to take the same risks the characters expect to face.

HIRING: To hire a retainer, a character must first find NPCs who are interested in the job. Characters will have to go somewhere they might find and interview interested NPCs, such as a tavern or they must pay a fee to advertise for NPCs to come and see them. The DM must create the personalities of the NPCs who come to the character for an interview.

Next the character must explain the duties of the job to the NPC and offer a rate of pay. The DM must decide what a good rate of pay would be, but this usually includes a guaranteed minimum fee and a partial share of any treasure found. Fees should vary depending on the skills of each retainer and the number available. Employers are expected to buy equipment and food for their retainers as well as pay their fees. Generally, if there are only a few jobs offered but many people looking for work, retainers may agree to work for less pay and vice versa.

REACTIONS: Once a rate of pay is offered the DM must roll 2d6 and consult the **Retainer Reaction** table to see if the offer is accepted, refused, or if more negotiation is necessary. The DM may want to adjust the reaction roll by +1 or +2 for very good offers or by -1 or -2 for poor offers or if the PC has a bad reputation.

Retainer Reactions

Dice Roll	Reaction
2	Offer refused; -1R*
3-5	Offer refused
6-8	Roll again
9-11	Offer accepted
12	Offer accepted; +1M†

*The DM should roll for each retainer found. If a 2 is rolled, reactions to that character of other retainers in the same area will be adjusted by -1. If the character attempts to hire retainers in some other town, reactions will be determined normally.

†The retainer is so friendly that his or her normal **morale** (an optional rule; see page B27) will be adjusted by +1.

LEVEL OF RETAINERS: A retainer may be of any level (0, 1, 2, 3, or higher) and of any class (normal man or a character class). Retainers can never be higher in level than the PC who hires them.

Elvish and dwarvish retainers should be very rare. Elves have very long lives, but their numbers are not great. Dwarves also have long lifespans (though not nearly so long as elves) but their numbers are greater (though not as great as the number of humans).

LOYALTY: The loyalty of a retainer is a measure of the retainer's morale and willingness to take risks for the PC and not run away in the face of danger. A retainer's loyalty or morale is based on the charisma of the player character employer (see page B7). The loyalty of retainers should be checked whenever extraordinary danger is met during an adventure. Loyalty should also be checked after each adventure. The DM may wish to adjust a retainer's loyalty due to actions of the player character, such as if the PC pays the retainer more than agreed upon, or rescues the retainer from danger and vice versa.

USING RETAINERS: Retainers are often used to strengthen a party which is attempting an extremely dangerous adventure. It is recommended that the DM **not** allow beginning players to hire retainers. New players tend to use retainers as a crutch, letting them take all the risks. If a dungeon is very difficult, the DM should let players have more than one character apiece *before* using retainers, at least until players are more experienced. **Hirelings** are experts which can be hired by the characters. They are more suited to higher level campaigns and are explained in the D&D EXPERT SET.

EXPERIENCE: Retainers will earn experience from adventures just like player characters do, and may rise a level in their character class once they have gained enough experience. Retainers, however, only receive 1/2 the experience PCs would receive, because